[illegible] Japan Dept 6

BRITISH EMBASSY
WASHINGTON

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SECRET

1069/2/16/520

21st January 1952.

[illegible] with record of conversation. 24/1

FJ 10310/44

Dear Shuckburgh,

The attached record of the Secretary of State's discussion with Mr. Acheson on January 10th about Japan's Relations with China was reconstructed from memory a week after the event. The Ambassador has seen the record and it accords with his recollection of what was said.

2. Roger Makins asked that copies of the record should go to him as well as to Norman Brook and Mallaby.

3. I enclose five copies and perhaps you will be good enough to let Brook, Makins and Mallaby have one each after you have satisfied yourself that the record contains nothing inconsistent with your own recollection of the meeting.

I agree

Yours ever
F S Tomlinson

F. S. Tomlinson

C.A.E. Shuckburgh, Esq., C.M.G.,
Foreign Office,
London S.W. 1

This record should be printed as Section print. Meanwhile copies should go in advance to Sir R Makins
Mr. R.H. Scott
Sir N Brook.

A copy has already been given to Defence Dept.

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ANNEX

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BRITISH RECORD

Discussion in State Department between Secretary of State and Mr. Acheson on January 10th

JAPAN'S RELATIONS WITH CHINA

Present

United Kingdom	United States
Secretary of State	Mr. Acheson
Sir Oliver Franks	Mr. Dulles
Mr. Shuckburgh	Mr. Perkins
Mr. Tomlinson	Mr. Gifford
	Mr. Allison

Mr. Acheson invited Mr. Dulles to explain the American position.

Mr. Dulles said his consistent objective throughout his work on the Japanese Peace Treaty had been to ensure the fullest possible understanding and agreement between the United States and United Kingdom. He had had this objective very much in mind in working out a solution to the difficult problem of China in relation to the Japanese Peace Treaty.

Speaking purely personally he thought that in their general policies towards China neither the United States nor the United Kingdom had yet found the right answer. He could not feel that either of the two countries would be satisfied to maintain their present policies indefinitely. It was perhaps therefore a mistake to think of Anglo/American relations in regard to China as though there were fixed positions on both sides. **Mr. Dulles** then gave a detailed account of various discussions he had had with United Kingdom representatives and with members of the Japanese Government on the subject of Japan's relations with China. He recalled that when he originally suggested in June 1951 that neither China should attend the Japanese Peace Conference and [illegible] whatever way she saw fit Mr. Attlee had objected to the proposal on the grounds that Japan would be certain to fall in line with the United States and enter into relations with the Chinese Nationalists. It was therefore clear that when the British Government eventually accepted Mr. Dulles's proposal they did so in the knowledge that the final result would inevitably be that Japan would chose a course which would harmonise with the policies of the United States Government. Mr. Dulles had in fact resisted the views of certain Senators who felt that Japan should at once conclude a treaty with the Chinese Nationalists, and no final commitment would be made until after the multilateral treaty came into force. Whether the Chinese Nationalists would seek to make difficulties about arrangements with Japan limited to the area under their control remained to be seen. The Japanese might well have wished to follow United States policy and recognise Chiang as the Government of all China. Mr. Dulles had however recommended against this. He understood that there had been some feeling amongst the British that his activities in Japan were an infringement of the spirit of the Dulles/Morrison agreement. It had never been his understanding of this agreement that it would prevent Japan taking action which she deemed to be in her own interests. The facts of the present relationship between Japan and the United States were such that it was unthinkable that for some years to come the Japanese Government should pursue policies in conflict with those of the United States.

Mr. Dulles referred to the fact that he had now received a communication from the Japanese Prime Minister stating the intentions of the Japanese Government and that it would probably be necessary to make use of this during the Senate's consideration of the Peace Treaty with Japan. He felt that the action he had taken was the minimum necessary to lead to the desired result in the U.S.A. and at the same time retain the spirit of the Dulles/Morrison Agreement.

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The Secretary of State said that he understood the American position. He had not however altered his own views and he could not agree that the course of action which the Americans felt compelled to purpose was wise in the circumstances. He still thought that the wisest course was that the Japanese Government should make no commitment until the coming into force of the multilateral treaty of peace. **Mr. Acheson** said that he would like to elaborate on some of the points made by Mr. Dulles. The Chinese Nationalists had some strong cards in their hands since there were certain Senators who were very responsive to any appeal by Chiang Kai-shek. The votes of one-third of the Senate would be sufficient to obstruct the ratification of the Japanese Peace Treaty and unless at any rate some limited agreement between Japan and Formosa were under contemplation the Chinese Nationalists might be able to induce their Senatorial friends to advocate a course which would be embarrassing for us all. These Senators might press for postponement of ratification until the Senate could examine in detail the text of a proposed agreement between Japan and Formosa. This would be bad enough but it would be even more distressing if they succeeded in attaching conditions to ratification, with the result that ratification would not become operative until after the signature of a treaty between Japan and Formosa. This would not only be bad for the United States but would confront the other signatories with a difficult problem.

The Secretary of State said that he appreciated the domestic difficulties faced by the United States Administration. He adhered, however, to the view that it would have been better if nothing need have been done or said until after the coming into effect of the multilateral treaty. If he were questioned he would have to say that his view was unchanged, and that he had made this known to the Americans. He was, however, glad to know that in any case the Japanese would take no final action to conclude arrangements with China before the coming into force of the Japanese Peace Treaty. It made some difference that no final action would be taken until the Japanese had recovered their full liberty of action. He did not wish this to become a major issue between our two countries and he thought this could be avoided. He must not, however, be regarded as having acquiesced in this development.

Mr. Acheson said that Sir E. Dening would unquestionably be asked by Mr. Yoshida about the outcome of the Washington conversations.

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He hoped that Sir E. Dening would be instructed to say that while still maintaining our view, we should not disagree if the Japanese wish to pursue discussions with Formosa on the lines recently discussed by Mr. Dulles in Tokyo. Mr. Eden said that this presented difficulties and the line proposed by Mr. Acheson was further than he was prepared to go.

After some discussion it was agreed that the United Kingdom would prepare a draft setting out the line Sir E. Dening might take in replying to any questions by Mr. Yoshida, which would be discussed with the Americans before despatch.

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